SSC CGL 2019 Tier-I question paper with answers

4 March 2020 · Shift 3

49 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 51 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20200710213341/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Final_Answer_key%20cgle19t1.pdf

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1

Name the author of the 2019 released book - 'The Scent of God'.

(A) Nayantara Sehgal
(B) Saikat Majumdar
(C) Githa Hariharan
(D) Himanjali Sankar

Q.2

Which of the following is an INCORRECT sequence of Mughal rulers?

(A) Akbar, Shah Jahan, Jahangir
(B) Jahangir, Shah Jahan, Aurangzeb
(C) Babur, Humayun, Akbar
(D) Akbar, Jahangir, Shah Jahan

Q.3

How many members did the International Monetary Fund (IMF) have as of January 2020?

(A) 164
(B) 189
(C) 182
(D) 174

Q.4

What is the name of the phenomena in physics and astronomy which involves the splitting of a spectral line into two or more components of slightly different frequency when the light source is placed in a magnetic field?

(A) Alpenglow Effect
(B) Lumen Effect
(C) Raman Effect
(D) Zeeman Effect

Q.5

The 3rd Khelo India Youth Games 2020 is hosted by which Indian state?

(A) Punjab
(B) Kerala
(C) Assam
(D) Karnataka

Q.6

Which of the following is an Indian Research Station in the Antarctica Region?

(A) Maitri
(B) Orcadas
(C) Mawson
(D) Hope Bay

Q.7

The American scientist Edwin Hubble's name is associated with which of these theories?

(A) The Big Bang Theory
(B) Quantum Chromodynamics Theory
(C) Partial Coherence of Light Theory
(D) Lattice Gauge Theory

Q.8

Name the company that has acquired an online travel portal Yatra Online Inc., for an enterprise value of $337.8 million, in an all-stock transaction.

(A) Trivago
(B) Ebix Inc.
(C) Trip Advisor
(D) Make my trip.com

Q.9

Former union minister and former Karnataka CM, D.V. Sadananda Gowda is a cabinet minister in the current central cabinet (February-2020). What is his portfolio?

(A) Chemicals and Fertilizers
(B) Public Distribution
(C) Tribal Affairs
(D) Law and Justice

Q.10

Which of these is the energy conversion that happens in the process called photosynthesis?

(A) Potential energy to chemical energy
(B) Heat energy to chemical energy
(C) Heat energy to light energy
(D) Light energy to chemical energy

Q.11

When does the entire earth experience equal days and nights?

(A) At orbital plane
(B) Day of summer solstice
(C) Day of winter solstice
(D) Day of equinox

Q.12

Who is the only scientist in the world to have won the Nobel prize in Chemistry twice?

(A) Linus Carl Pauling
(B) Roger D. Kornberg
(C) Frederick Sanger
(D) Madame Curie

Q.13

Who was the then Governor-General of British India, when 'Sati Pratha' became illegal and punishable?

(A) Lord William Bentinck
(B) Lord Cornwallis
(C) Lord Wellesley
(D) Warren Hastings

Q.14

From which of the following states does 2019 Padma Vibhushan winner, Teejan Bai hail?

(A) Telangana
(B) Odisha
(C) Gujarat
(D) Chhattisgarh

Q.15

Iranian Major General Qasem Soleimani was recently (2020) assassinated by the US military in _____.

(A) Saudi Arabia
(B) Iraq
(C) Pakistan
(D) United Arab Emirates

Q.16

Who among the following is the current (January 2020) Governor of Kerala?

(A) Arif Mohammed Khan
(B) B.D. Mishra
(C) Satya Pal Mallik
(D) Lalji Tandon

Q.17

Four multi-storied illegal constructions - Jain Coral Cove, H20 Holy Faith, Alfa Serene and Golden Kayaloram - were razed to the ground in January 2020 following Supreme Court instructions. In which state did this happen?

(A) Kerala
(B) Tamil Nadu
(C) Karnataka
(D) Goa

Q.18

What is the name of the phenomena (driven by the scattering of light) in which mountain tops acquire a rosy or orange hue around sunrise and sunset?

(A) Barrel distortion
(B) Circle of confusion
(C) Alpenglow
(D) Brillouin scattering

Q.19

Name the two Indian actors who shared the National Best Actor Award (Male) in the 66th National Film Awards 2019.

(A) Ayushmann Khurrana and Vicky Kaushal
(B) Nana Patekar and Mohanlal
(C) Amitabh Bachchan and Ranbir Kapoor
(D) Ranbir Kapoor and Akshay Kumar

Q.20
Bhavai and Kalbelia as traditional dance forms, owe their genesis to which Indian state?

(A) Rajasthan
(B) Assam
(C) Punjab
(D) Odisha

Q.21
Who is the author of the delightful and anecdotal history of Indian cricket titled - 'A Corner of a Foreign Field: The Indian History of a British Sport'?

(A) Bipin Chandra
(B) Romila Thapar
(C) Ramachandra Guha
(D) Sanjay Singh

Q.22
The city of Vijayawada lies on the banks of which of these rivers?

(A) Godavari
(B) Tapti
(C) Mahanadi
(D) Krishna

Q.23
Only one Indian batsman has scored a triple century in test cricket other than Virender Sehwag. Name this batsman.

(A) Rohit Sharma
(B) Ajinkya Rahane
(C) Shikhar Dhawan
(D) Karun Nair

Q.24
Who among the following is known as the 'father of Muslim renaissance' in Bengal?

(A) Ameer Ali
(B) Nawab Abdul Latif Khan
(C) Nawab Salimullah Khan
(D) Sir Sayed Ahmed Khan

Q.25
The recently revoked 'Article 370' is associated with which of these states of India?

(A) Kashmir
(B) Sikkim
(C) Assam
(D) Nagaland

English Comprehension 24 questions

Q.1
Given below are four jumbled sentences. Out of the given options pick the one that gives their correct order. A. Upon returning from his travels, he was forced to live in a house where his large family lived. B. Vaikom Muhammad Basheer was a Malayalam fiction writer from Vaikom in Kerala. C. The household was always noisy and full of chaos, no place for a writer surely! D. Apart from family members, myriads of domestic animals also treated the house as their own.

(A) BADC
(B) BCAD
(C) BDCA
(D) BCDA

Q.2
Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Sparse

(A) Costly
(B) Scanty
(C) Abundant
(D) Tranquil

Q.3
Select the correct passive form of the given sentence. Did the problems you had to face discourage you?

(A) Have you been discouraged by the problems you have to face?
(B) Were you discouraged by the problems you had to face?
(C) Are you being discouraged by the problems you had to face?
(D) Are you discouraged by the problems you had to face?

Q.4
Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Being a millionaire, he is leading a _____ life.

(A) luxurious
(B) conducive
(C) destitute
(D) expensive

Q.5

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Influence
(B) Itinerent
(C) Ignorance
(D) Impeach

Q.6

Select the word which means the same as the group of words given. One who is preoccupied with his own interests

(A) Pessimist
(B) Atheist
(C) Egoist
(D) Optimist

Q.7

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Milton Hershey returned to the village where he had been born, in the heart of dairy country. He opened his chocolate manufacturing plant (1)_____ 1905. With access to all the fresh milk he (2)_____, he began producing the finest milk chocolate. The plant (3)_____ opened in a small Pennsylvania village is today the (4)_____ chocolate factory in the world. The confections created here are (5)_____ around the world.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank 1.

(A) at
(B) on
(C) in
(D) to

Q.8

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Milton Hershey returned to the village where he had been born, in the heart of dairy country. He opened his chocolate manufacturing plant (1)_____ 1905. With access to all the fresh milk he (2)_____, he began producing the finest milk chocolate. The plant (3)_____ opened in a small Pennsylvania village is today the (4)_____ chocolate factory in the world. The confections created here are (5)_____ around the world.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank 2.

(A) distributed
(B) kneaded
(C) needed
(D) considered

Q.9

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Milton Hershey returned to the village where he had been born, in the heart of dairy country. He opened his chocolate manufacturing plant (1)_____ 1905. With access to all the fresh milk he (2)_____, he began producing the finest milk chocolate. The plant (3)_____ opened in a small Pennsylvania village is today the (4)_____ chocolate factory in the world. The confections created here are (5)_____ around the world.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank 3.

(A) that
(B) what
(C) who
(D) when

Q.10

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Milton Hershey returned to the village where he had been born, in the heart of dairy country. He opened his chocolate manufacturing plant (1)_____ 1905. With access to all the fresh milk he (2)_____, he began producing the finest milk chocolate. The plant (3)_____ opened in a small Pennsylvania village is today the (4)_____ chocolate factory in the world. The confections created here are (5)_____ around the world.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank 4.

(A) most largest
(B) largest
(C) larger
(D) large

Q.11

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Milton Hershey returned to the village where he had been born, in the heart of dairy country. He opened his chocolate manufacturing plant (1)_____ 1905. With access to all the fresh milk he (2)_____, he began producing the finest milk chocolate. The plant (3)_____ opened in a small Pennsylvania village is today the (4)_____ chocolate factory in the world. The confections created here are (5)_____ around the world.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank 5.

(A) collections
(B) choices
(C) selections
(D) favourites

Q.12

Select the word which means the same as the group of words given. A geometrical figure with eight sides

(A) Hexagon
(B) Pentagon
(C) Octagon
(D) Heptagon

Q.13

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Solitary

(A) Stubborn
(B) Splendid
(C) Sensible
(D) Singular

Q.14

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Hold water

(A) To be valid
(B) To be fickle
(C) To be deep
(D) To be busy

Q.15

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Fury

(A) Anger
(B) Crime
(C) Risk
(D) Sin

Q.16

In the sentence identify the segment which contains the grammatical error. I am believing you have submitted all the necessary documents.

(A) all the
(B) necessary documents
(C) you have submitted
(D) I am believing

Q.17

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Bring to light

(A) Brighten up
(B) Praise in public
(C) Cheer someone
(D) Reveal clearly

Q.18

Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence. The lawyer said to me, "There is no proof of your involvement in this case."

(A) The lawyer told that there is no proof of my involvement in that case.
(B) The lawyer told me that there is no proof of your involvement in this case.
(C) The lawyer said me that there was no proof of my involvement in this case.
(D) The lawyer told me that there was no proof of my involvement in that case.

Q.19

In the sentence identify the segment which contains the grammatical error. No sooner did we receive your message when we heaved a sigh of relief.

(A) when we heaved
(B) a sigh of relief
(C) your message
(D) did we receive

Q.20

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution'. Your advice will “benefit to me.”

(A) benefit me
(B) No substitution
(C) benefit for me
(D) benefit from me

Q.21

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Friendship

(A) Arrogance
(B) Amity
(C) Slavery
(D) Enmity

Q.22

Given below are four jumbled sentences. Out of the given options pick the one that gives their correct order. A. Even the most ill-equipped laboratory would have been better than their shed. B. Thus, they did not allow any difficulties to come in their way. C. But their mind was set upon the discovery of radium. D. The Curies had to work in extreme poverty.

(A) ABCD
(B) ADBC
(C) DACB
(D) DBCA

Q.23

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Children under five years are _____ from passport biometrics.

(A) acquitted
(B) escaped
(C) exempted
(D) allowed

Q.24

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select No substitution. “Where you left” your bag yesterday?

(A) No substitution
(B) Where were you leaving
(C) Where did you left
(D) Where did you leave

Answer key

General Awareness

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(A)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(C)**
Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(C)**
Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(B)**
Q.25 **(A)**					

English Comprehension

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(C)**
Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(D)**
Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(D)**

Explanations

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (B) Saikat Majumdar

'The Scent of God' (2019), a novel set in a boys' boarding school run by a Hindu monastic order, is by Saikat Majumdar.

Q.2 · Answer (A) Akbar, Shah Jahan, Jahangir

The Mughal emperors ruled in the order Babur, Humayun, Akbar, Jahangir, Shah Jahan, Aurangzeb. Jahangir came before his son Shah Jahan, so 'Akbar, Shah Jahan, Jahangir' is out of order.

Q.3 · Answer (B) 189

The IMF had 189 member countries in January 2020, Nauru having joined as the 189th in 2016. (Andorra became the 190th in October 2020.)

Q.4 · Answer (D) Zeeman Effect

The Zeeman effect, found by Pieter Zeeman in 1896, is the splitting of a spectral line when the source is in a magnetic field. The Raman effect is a change in the wavelength of scattered light.

Q.5 · Answer (C) Assam

The third Khelo India Youth Games were held in Guwahati, Assam, in January 2020.

Q.6 · Answer (A) Maitri

Maitri, opened in 1989, and Bharati are India's working research stations in Antarctica. Orcadas is an Argentine station and Mawson an Australian one.

Q.7 · Answer (A) The Big Bang Theory

In 1929 Hubble showed that galaxies are moving away from us at speeds proportional to their distance (Hubble's law). This expansion of the universe is one of the main pieces of evidence for the Big Bang theory.

Q.8 · Answer (B) Ebix Inc.

In July 2019 the US company Ebix Inc. agreed to buy Yatra Online in this all-stock deal; when the exam was held (March 2020) the merger had been agreed but not completed. (It never closed: Yatra called it off in June 2020.)

Q.9 · Answer (A) Chemicals and Fertilizers

In February 2020 D. V. Sadananda Gowda was Union Minister of Chemicals and Fertilizers, a post he held from May 2019 to July 2021.

Q.10 · Answer (D) Light energy to chemical energy

In photosynthesis green plants use the energy of sunlight to make glucose from carbon dioxide and water, storing light energy as chemical energy.

Q.11 · Answer (D) Day of equinox

At the equinoxes, about 21 March and 23 September, the Sun is overhead at the equator and day and night are of equal length all over the earth. At the solstices the days are longest in one hemisphere and shortest in the other.

Q.12 · Answer (C) Frederick Sanger

When the exam was held (March 2020), Frederick Sanger was the only person to have won the Chemistry prize twice: in 1958, for the structure of insulin, and in 1980, for sequencing DNA. Marie Curie won Physics and Chemistry, and Linus Pauling Chemistry and Peace. (Barry Sharpless became the second double Chemistry laureate in 2022.)

Q.13 · Answer (A) Lord William Bentinck

Lord William Bentinck's Bengal Sati Regulation of 1829 declared sati illegal and punishable by the criminal courts.

Q.14 · Answer (D) Chhattisgarh

Teejan Bai, the Pandavani singer who performs the Mahabharata, is from Chhattisgarh; she received the Padma Vibhushan in 2019.

Q.15 · Answer (B) Iraq

Qasem Soleimani was killed in a US drone strike at Baghdad airport, Iraq, on 3 January 2020.

Q.16 · Answer (A) Arif Mohammed Khan

In January 2020 the Governor of Kerala was Arif Mohammed Khan, appointed in September 2019.

Q.17 · Answer (A) Kerala
The four apartment complexes at Maradu, near Kochi in Kerala, had been built in breach of Coastal Regulation Zone rules; on the Supreme Court's orders they were brought down by controlled implosion in January 2020.

Q.18 · Answer (C) Alpenglow
Alpenglow is the rosy or orange glow on high peaks just before sunrise or after sunset, when they catch light scattered in the atmosphere. Barrel distortion and the circle of confusion are terms from optics and photography.

Q.19 · Answer (A) Ayushmann Khurrana and Vicky Kaushal
At the 66th National Film Awards (for 2018), Ayushmann Khurrana ('Andhadhun') and Vicky Kaushal ('Uri: The Surgical Strike') shared the Best Actor award.

Q.20 · Answer (A) Rajasthan
Bhavai, in which dancers balance a stack of pots on their heads, and Kalbelia, the dance of the Kalbelia snake-charmer community, are folk dances of Rajasthan.

Q.21 · Answer (C) Ramachandra Guha
Ramachandra Guha's 'A Corner of a Foreign Field' (2002) traces the history of cricket in India from colonial times.

Q.22 · Answer (D) Krishna
Vijayawada, in Andhra Pradesh, stands on the Krishna, where the Prakasam Barrage crosses the river.

Q.23 · Answer (D) Karun Nair
Karun Nair scored 303 not out against England at Chennai in December 2016; when the exam was held (March 2020) he and Virender Sehwag were India's only Test triple-centurions.

Q.24 · Answer (B) Nawab Abdul Latif Khan
Nawab Abdul Latif, who founded the Mohammedan Literary Society in Calcutta in 1863 to spread modern education among Muslims, is called the father of the Muslim renaissance in Bengal.

Q.25 · Answer (A) Kashmir
Article 370 gave Jammu and Kashmir its special status. It was made inoperative in August 2019, and the state was reorganised into two Union Territories.

English Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (A) BADC
B introduces Basheer, A tells how he came home to live with his large family, D adds the many animals that shared the house, and C concludes that it was no place for a writer: BADC.

Q.2 · Answer (C) Abundant
'Sparse' means thinly scattered or scanty; its opposite is 'abundant'. 'Scanty' is a synonym.

Q.3 · Answer (B) Were you discouraged by the problems you had to face?
The simple past question 'Did … discourage you?' becomes 'Were you discouraged by …?'; the clause 'you had to face' stays in the past.

Q.4 · Answer (A) luxurious
A millionaire leads a 'luxurious' life, one of comfort and costly pleasures; 'destitute' means very poor.

Q.5 · Answer (B) Itinerent
The correct spelling is 'itinerant'.

Q.6 · Answer (C) Egoist
An egoist is self-centred, concerned chiefly with his own interests.

Q.7 · Answer (C) in
A year takes 'in': 'in 1905'.

Q.8 · Answer (C) needed
'All the fresh milk he needed'; 'kneaded', which sounds the same, means worked like dough.

Q.9 · Answer (A) that
The relative pronoun for a thing is 'that': 'The plant that opened in a small Pennsylvania village'.

Q.10 · Answer (B) largest
Compared with every other factory 'in the world', the superlative: 'the largest'. 'Most largest' is a double superlative.

Q.11 · Answer (D) favourites
The confections are popular everywhere: 'favourites around the world'.

Q.12 · Answer (C) Octagon
An octagon has eight sides; a pentagon has five, a hexagon six and a heptagon seven.

Q.13 · Answer (D) Singular
'Solitary' means single, the only one ('a solitary example'): 'singular'.

Q.14 · Answer (A) To be valid
An argument that 'holds water' stands up to examination: it is valid.

Q.15 · Answer (A) Anger
'Fury' is violent anger.

Q.16 · Answer (D) I am believing
'Believe' is a stative verb and is not used in the continuous tense: 'I believe you have submitted all the necessary documents.'

Q.17 · Answer (D) Reveal clearly
To 'bring to light' is to reveal or make known.

Q.18 · Answer (D) The lawyer told me that there was no proof of my involvement in that case.
'Said to me' becomes 'told me', 'is' becomes 'was', 'your' becomes 'my' and 'this' becomes 'that'.

Q.19 · Answer (A) when we heaved
'No sooner' is followed by 'than', not 'when': 'No sooner did we receive your message than we heaved a sigh of relief.'

Q.20 · Answer (A) benefit me
'Benefit' takes a direct object, without 'to': 'Your advice will benefit me.'

Q.21 · Answer (D) Enmity
The opposite of 'friendship' is 'enmity'; 'amity' is a synonym.

Q.22 · Answer (C) DACB
D states the Curies' poverty, A describes their shed, C ('But') turns to their resolve to discover radium, and B ('Thus') concludes that no difficulty stopped them: DACB.

Q.23 · Answer (C) exempted
To be 'exempted' from a requirement is to be freed from it; 'acquitted' is said of a person cleared of a charge.

Q.24 · Answer (D) Where did you leave
A question in the simple past needs 'did' with the base form of the verb: 'Where did you leave your bag yesterday?'

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